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The eyes might be the window to the soul but shoes are a window to everything else. What shoes you wear can say a lot about you. A study done by researchers at the University of Kansas found that people were able to accurately judge 90 per cent of a stranger's personal characteristics such as age, income, political affiliation and more just by looking at the style, colour and condition of their shoes. While that sounds like the perfect game for when you are out pub-hopping with your friends, do consider what your shoes say about yourself. For instance, if you are wearing dirty or scuffed shoes, others may think of you as someone who doesn't care about their outward appearance, or maybe is just plain lazy and a slob. On the other hand, someone with conspicuously shined shoes might come across as extremely competent, or a perfectionist.

While different styles of shoes come and go, there are some classics that are a must in any man's wardrobe. Take for instance, the Oxford. A classic Oxford will get you through more moments in your life than any other men's shoe possibly could. You can wear them to work (and interviews), weddings, funerals, dinner dates, and everything else in between. A symbol of timeless sophistication and elegance, the classic shoe has a rich history dating back to the 17th century. Originally called 'Balmorals' after the Queen's castle in Scotland—a particular style of Ox-

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fords are still called Balmorals—the shoe style was an evolution of more primitive footwear. Supposedly invented by Prince Albert, the husband of Queen Victoria who wore lace-up boots for hunting, the first time the term Oxford shoe appears in writing is around 1846. The key feature of Oxfords is their closed lacing system, which gives them a sleek and formal appearance. While the traditional black is the most classic option, you can also opt for brown or tan variations.

For the smart-casual or semi-formal look, the loafer is a must. Its history is in keeping with its style statement—casual and non-fussy. Originally inspired by shoes worn by Norwegian fisherman in the early 20th century, the modern loafer as we know it was popularised in the US in 1936, when it was introduced. With its slip-on design and comfortable fit, it became an instant success.

For less formal occasions, you could invest in a pair of monk straps. With a simple buckle strap closure in

